[redacted]T Roadmap 2025

Introduction and Purpose

The [redacted]s a proudly product driven organisation, where innovation, learner experience, and platform evolution take centre stage. While this product-centric approach has enabled rapid development and delivery, it is equally critical to recognise the foundational role of Information Technology in enabling, securing, and scaling our operations.

This document outlines the **IT Roadmap** for the business, a structured, forward looking guide that aligns our technology operations with global best practices and compliance frameworks such as **ITIL**, **NIST**, and **ISO** standards. Its purpose is to establish a shared understanding of the role IT plays not only in supporting the product but in delivering core business services, ensuring operational resilience, and enabling strategic innovation.

As the business grows in complexity and reach, a clearly defined IT roadmap ensures that:

- We have the right infrastructure, processes, and controls to support scale
- We actively manage risk, cybersecurity, and compliance
- We drive operational efficiency while reducing unnecessary complexity or cost
- We continuously enable our teams through reliable systems, data integrity, and user support
- We create space for innovation, including responsible AI adoption, automation, and DevOps acceleration

This roadmap is not a static plan but a living blueprint. It will evolve as our business needs change, as new technologies emerge, and as the regulatory landscape shifts. It serves as both a strategic compass for leadership and a tactical playbook for the IT function to execute against.

Ultimately, this roadmap is about intentionally shaping our IT ecosystem, not just reacting to product needs, but proactively laying the foundations that allows our business to scale securely, efficiently, and sustainably

From Shadow Work → Strategic Pillar

For any product driven organisation, the operational engine of Information Technology often performs its most critical work in the background. This essential shadow work, from daily system monitoring to proactive security hardening ensures the stability, security, and scalability upon which our product innovation is built.

The goal of this H2 initiative is to bring this foundational work to light by developing a comprehensive IT Roadmap. This roadmap is not a separate plan but a strategic pillar designed to run parallel to the Technical Product Roadmap, making the full scope of the Systems Team's activities and priorities visible and understandable to the business.

To achieve this, we will move through four distinct phases, transforming our operational tasks into a clear, strategic journey. Each phase is designed to build upon the last, ensuring we move from understanding our current state to embedding a forward looking, resilient IT strategy into our core business processes.

The following would be the POA to translate that strategic why into a tactical how and what!

Phase 1 → Discovery and Baseline → Duration of September 2025

This phase is all about understanding exactly where we are right now so we can build a realistic plan to get to our to be state.

- **Conduct Full Systems and Process Audit:**
  - We cannot map the future if we do not know the present. This means auditing everything, like software licenses, hardware assets, cloud assets, every S3 bucket, every EC2 instance, network diagrams, and subscription owners
  - **The takeaway task** → Review all existing documentation like our patching policies, DR plans, access controls and identify immediate gaps against our industry standards
- **Key Stakeholder Check Ins:**
  - Seeing that Keletso has been a part of cross departmental syncs, we can schedule sessions with leads from AIT, Data, Finance and Academic Divisions to identify their main operational pain points, their strategic priorities, and most importantly their dependency points on the **TPR**
- **Internal Team Capability Assessment:**

- Schedule a session with Vuyo and Keletso (and with the IT Support Specialist when they arrive) to clearly map our collective skills, single points of failure, and time capacity against the 7 Pillars. This will give me more ammo for my measurable goal of identifying 2026 H1 gaps

Phase 2 → Drafting and Alignment → Q4 2025

This is the core building phase, where we take our audit data and stakeholder needs and forge them into the actual roadmap document and Systems Overview

- **Define Initiatives for all 7 Pillars:**
  - This is the biggest task for us, for each of the 7 Pillars, we would need to create a backlog of specific initiatives → *currently taking place on the Systems Team Overview*
  - We will classify every single initiative into our three goal categories:
    - **Hygiene** → As an example would be to implement formal weekly patching schedule, run bi-annual phishing simulations
    - **Project** → As an example would be execute AWS Cost Optimisation or Google Drive Revamp
    - **Vision and Innovation** → As an example would be to evaluate Fin for other aspects of the business, develop Infrastructure as Code standards
- **Visual Roadmap:**
  - For the purposes of Cathy presenting to SLT, we will transfer these prioritised initiatives into Jira Product Discovery. This visualisation will clearly show timelines, status, and the primary pillar it supports. This is main deliverable for stakeholder visibility.
- **Confluence Expansion:**
  - We will then take the visual roadmap and use the [redacted]T Roadmap 2025 parent page as the foundation and create child pages detailing the what, why, and how for each major initiative. This is where we will document the specifics for each initiative
- **Internal Alignment and Comms Plan:**
  - Discuss with Cathy how we will share this with business, how they can give feedback, and how they can see progress. This ensures the roadmap doesn't just land but is adopted.

Phase 3 → Review and Finalisation → End Q4 2025 to Jan 2026

This phase is about getting the buy in that makes the roadmap official and acknowledged by the business rather than it just being a backlog of tasks that the Systems Team works from.

- **Present Draft to SLT for Approval:**
  - We will need to schedule a formal review session with the SLT. The goal is to get their approval, confirming strategic alignment which is one of my key measurable items
- **Present Roadmap to Systems Team:**
  - By this time, we will most certainly have new roadmap ideas to work from but here I would like to hold a dedicated session with my team to review the approved roadmap. This is where we align their individual priorities and OKRs directly to these roadmap initiatives
- **Publish Roadmap to Business Stakeholders:**
  - Execute the comms plan task, this will achieve my visibility measurable

Phase 4 → Operationalise and Embed → Feb 2026

This final phase ensures the roadmap does not just become a forgotten document.

- **Establish Review Cadence:**
  - This may already take place in my 1:1 with Cathy OR we will have dedicated sessions for this. We must know that we cannot run Systems iniatives like we do Product however we will ask the sprint backlog related questions like, what did we complete? What's blocked? What needs to change based on new business needs?
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- **Finalise and Submit 2026 H1 Gap Report:**
  - Using my capability assessment mentioned above and the approved roadmap, we can deliver the formal document outlining the critical capability or delivery gaps in terms of people, skills, tools or budget needed to succeed in 2026